

IRB consent form

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Consent to Participate in Research

Principal Investigator: Devin Pope

This is a study being conducted by researchers at the University of Chicago to understand the ability of people to predict the happiness of American subgroups.

In order to participate in this online study, **you must be 18 years of age or older.**

The information collected may be published in articles or academic presentations, but your personal identity or your involvement as a research subject will not be published or revealed. Information collected during this study will be retained by the researchers and may be used in future research projects, but again, your personal identity or involvement will not be published or revealed.

Participation is on a purely voluntary basis. This study does not involve any physical or emotional risk to you beyond the risks of daily life. Your involvement in this experiment may benefit the field of economics by helping to advance theories about prediction ability.

Your involvement in this study is appreciated, but you may quit participation altogether at any time without receiving any penalty or prejudice.

If you have questions about this project, you may contact us at:

Hannah Lybbert

University of Chicago Booth School of Business

5807 South Woodlawn Avenue

Chicago, IL 60637

Email: hannah.lybbert@chicagobooth.edu

If you have any questions about your rights as a participant in this research, you can contact the following office at the University of Chicago:

Social & Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board

University of Chicago,

1155 E 60th Street Room #411

Chicago, IL 60637

Phone: 773-834-7835

Email: sbs-irb@uchicago.edu

After you have reviewed the information provided above, please click on the "yes" button below if you wish to participate in this survey. To be eligible to participate, please remember that you must be 18 years of age or older.

. Do you wish to participate in this research study?

- ☐ Yes, I wish to participate
- ☐ No, I do not wish to participate

Respondent happiness

. Thank you for taking this survey. It should take about **5-10 minutes** to complete.

To get started, we have a very simple question for you:

. Taken all together, how would you say things are these days -- would you say that you are very happy, pretty happy, or not too happy?

- ☐ Very happy
- ☐ Pretty happy
- ☐ Not too happy

Survey Introduction

. You just answered a question about your own happiness. That same question — "Taken all together, how would you say things are these days—would you say that you are very happy, pretty happy, or not too happy?" — has been asked on a survey to a large number of American adults from 2004–2024. Responses were converted to numbers: 1 = Not too happy, 2 = Pretty happy, 3 = Very happy. The overall average happiness was 2.09 out of 3.

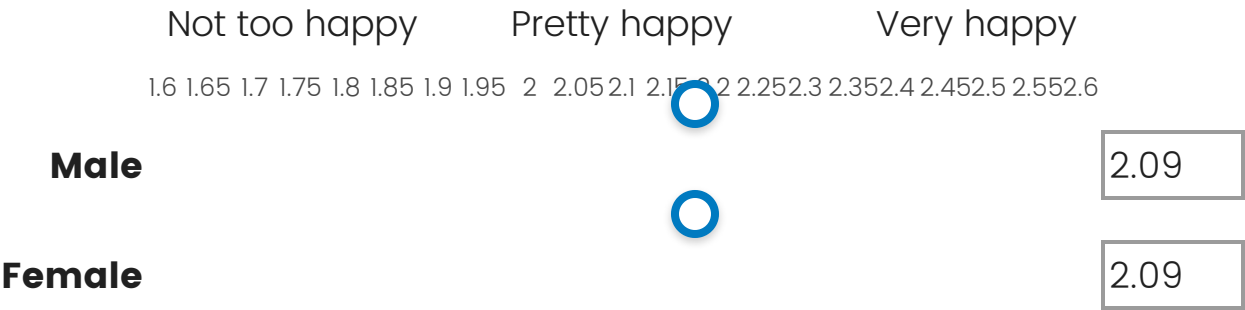
We are interested in your predictions about which groups in the United States are the happiest. For different groups of Americans, please use the sliders on the following page to indicate **how happy you think that group is on average**.

Important: Happiness levels for different groups are available in public data, and AI tools could also generate these estimates. We're not testing your ability to look up the right answer — we want to know what you intuitively think. Please answer using your **own knowledge and best guess**, without searching the internet or using AI tools.

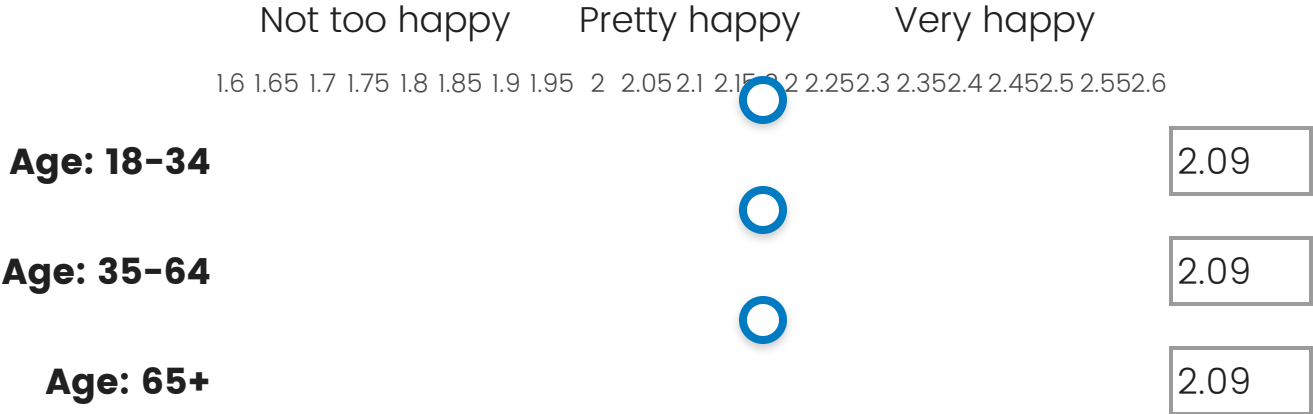
Happiness Prediction Questions

. **Reminder:** happiness is measured on a scale of 1 = Not too happy, 2 = Pretty happy, 3 = Very happy. The dashed line on each slider marks the national average of 2.09

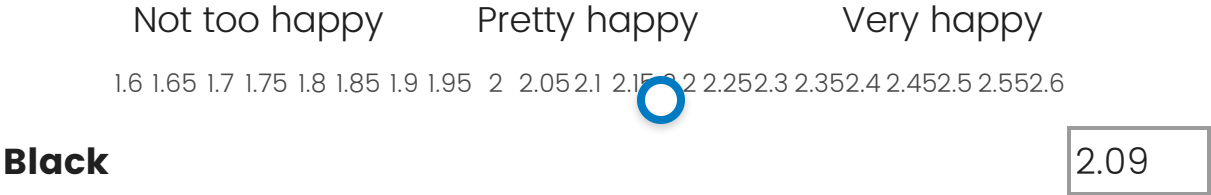
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **sex**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **age**

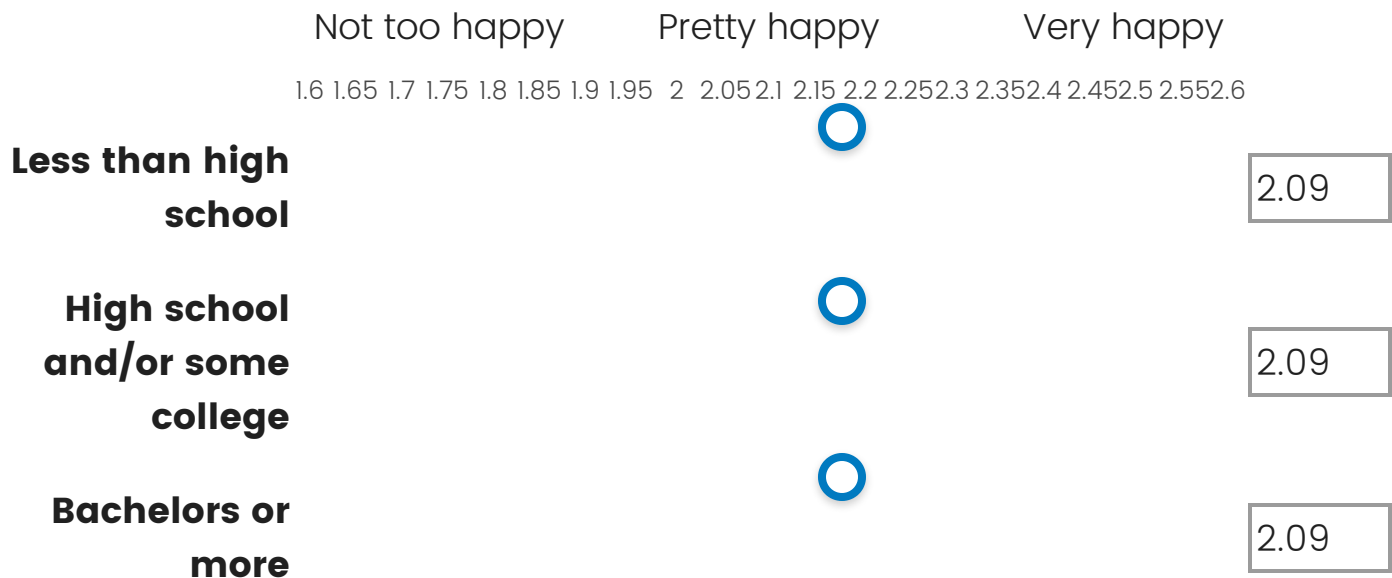


. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **race**





. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **education**



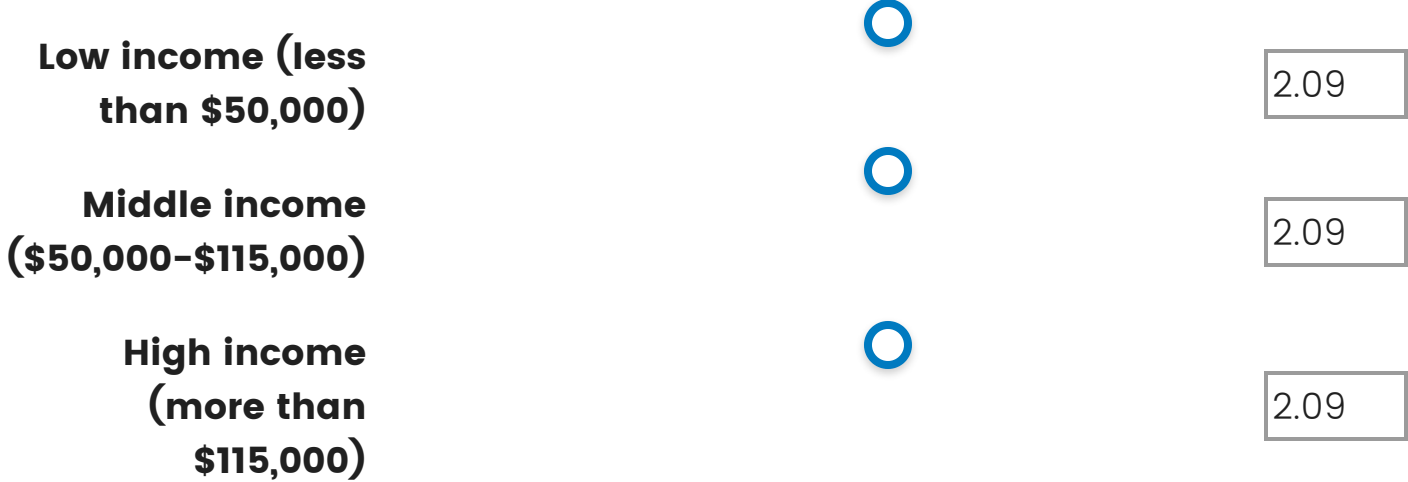
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **household income**

Not too happy

Pretty happy

Very happy

1.6 1.65 1.7 1.75 1.8 1.85 1.9 1.95 2 2.05 2.1 2.15 2.2 2.25 2.3 2.35 2.4 2.45 2.5 2.55 2.6



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **marital status**

Not too happy

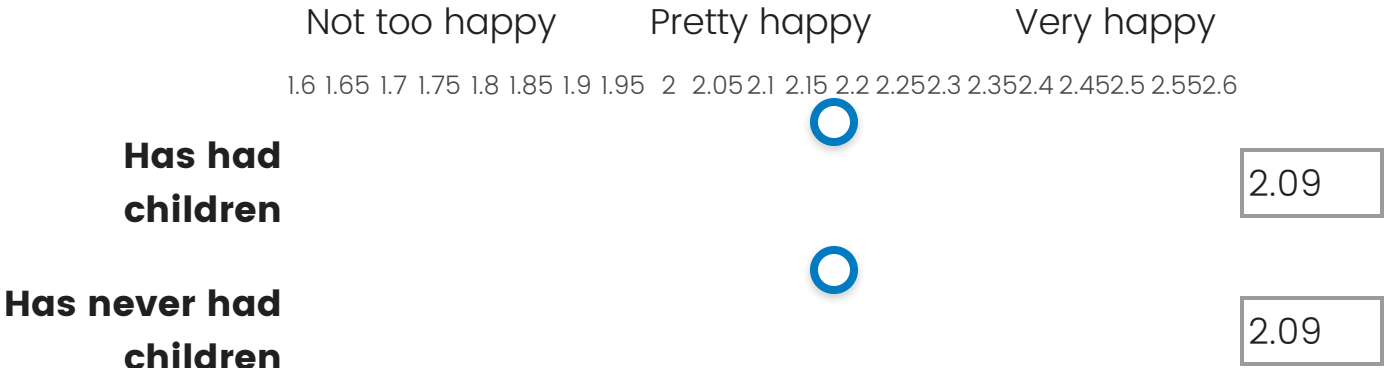
Pretty happy

Very happy

1.6 1.65 1.7 1.75 1.8 1.85 1.9 1.95 2 2.05 2.1 2.15 2.2 2.25 2.3 2.35 2.4 2.45 2.5 2.55 2.6



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on whether they have **ever had children**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on frequency of **religious attendance**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group

based on **political party**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on the **type of area where they live**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **physical health** status



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on how often they **socialize with friends**



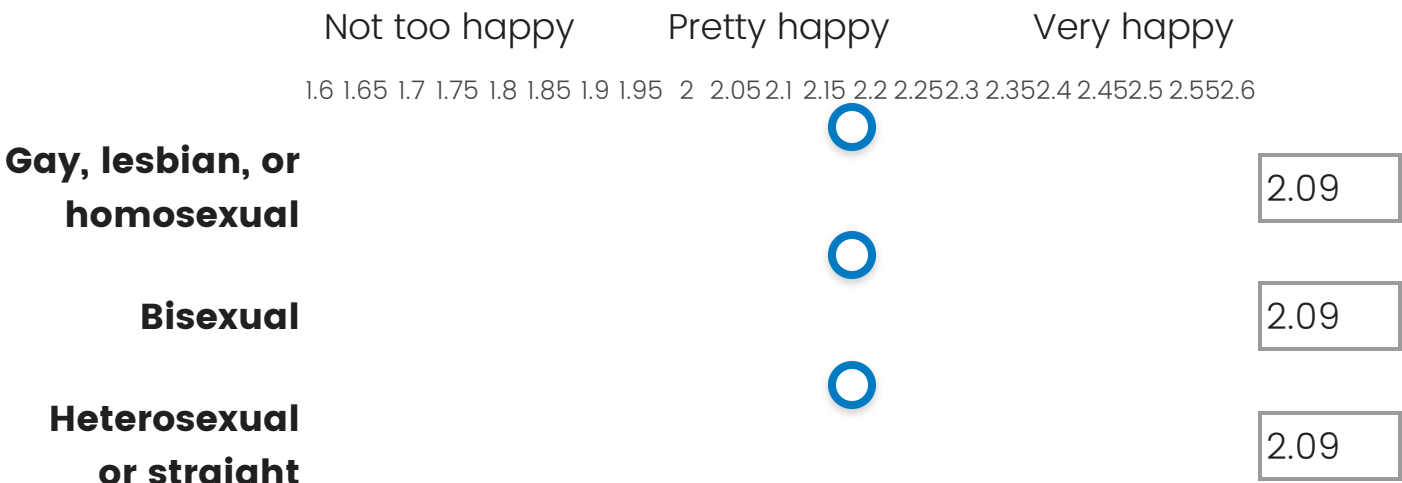
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **recent life event**



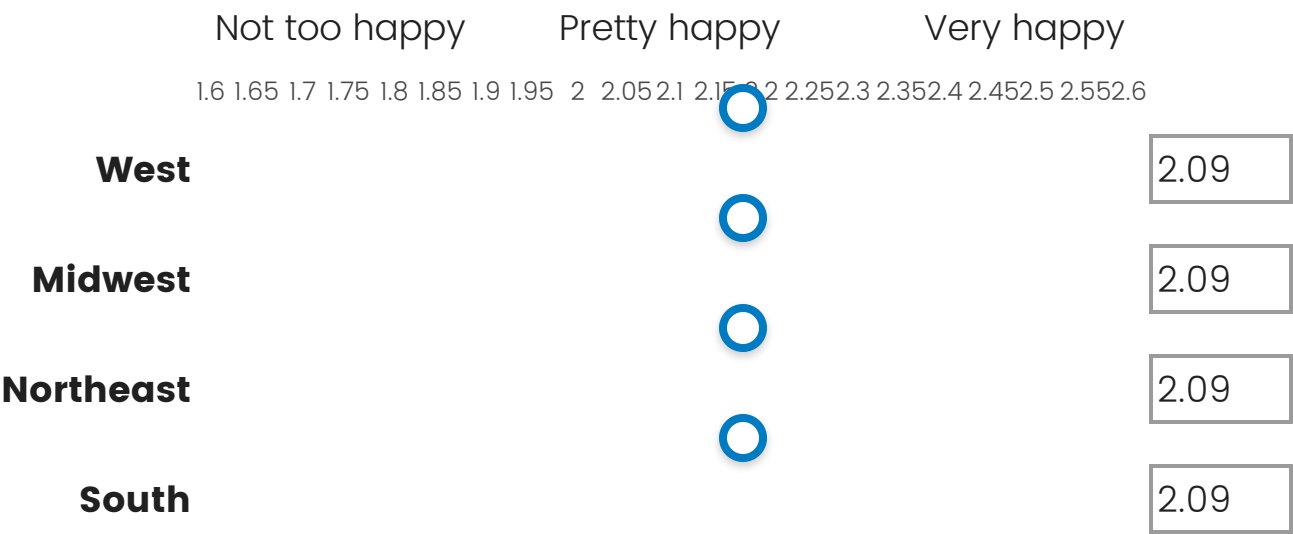
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **recent life event**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **sexual orientation**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on the **region of the U.S. where they live**



Respondent Demographics questions

. And now, a few final questions about you.

. How old are you?

- ☐ 18-24
- ☐ 25-34
- ☐ 35-44
- ☐ 45-54
- ☐ 55-64
- ☐ 65+

. What is your sex?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Other

. What do you consider your primary race?

- ☐ White

- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ Hispanic
- ☐ Other

. What is the highest level of education you have completed?

- ☐ Less than high school
- ☐ High school
- ☐ Associate/Junior college
- ☐ Bachelor's
- ☐ Graduate

. In which of these groups did your total family income, from all sources, fall last year before taxes?

- ☐ Less than \$50,000
- ☐ \$50,000-\$115,000
- ☐ Greater than \$115,000

. Are you currently married, widowed, divorced, separated, or have you never been married?

- ☐ Married
- ☐ Widowed
- ☐ Divorced
- ☐ Separated
- ☐ Never married

. How many children have you ever had? Please count all that were born alive at any time (including any you had from a previous marriage).

- ☐ 0
- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5 or more

. How often do you attend religious services?

- ☐ Several times a week
- ☐ Every week
- ☐ Nearly every week
- ☐ 2-3 times a month
- ☐ About once a month
- ☐ Several times a year

- ☐ About once a year
- ☐ Less than once a year
- ☐ Never

. Generally speaking, do you usually think of yourself as a Republican, Democrat, Independent, or another party?

- ☐ Strong democrat
- ☐ Not very strong democrat
- ☐ Independent, close to democrat
- ☐ Independent (neither)
- ☐ Independent, close to republican
- ☐ Not very strong republican
- ☐ Strong republican
- ☐ Other party

. Which best describes the area where you currently live?

- ☐ Big city (over 250,000)
- ☐ Medium size city (50,000 to 250,000)
- ☐ Suburb of a big or medium size city
- ☐ Small town (10,000 to 49,999)
- ☐ Rural town (1,000 to 9,999)

. Would you say your own health, in general, is excellent, good, fair, or poor?

- ☐ Excellent
- ☐ Good
- ☐ Fair
- ☐ Poor

. Please select the answer that comes closest to how often you spend a social evening with friends.

- ☐ Almost daily
- ☐ Once or twice a week
- ☐ Several times a month
- ☐ About once a month
- ☐ Several times a year
- ☐ About once a year
- ☐ Never

. Which state the U.S. do you currently live in?

. Which of the following best describes you?

- ☐ Gay, lesbian, or homosexual
- ☐ Bisexual
- ☐ Heterosexual or straight
- ☐ Other

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